

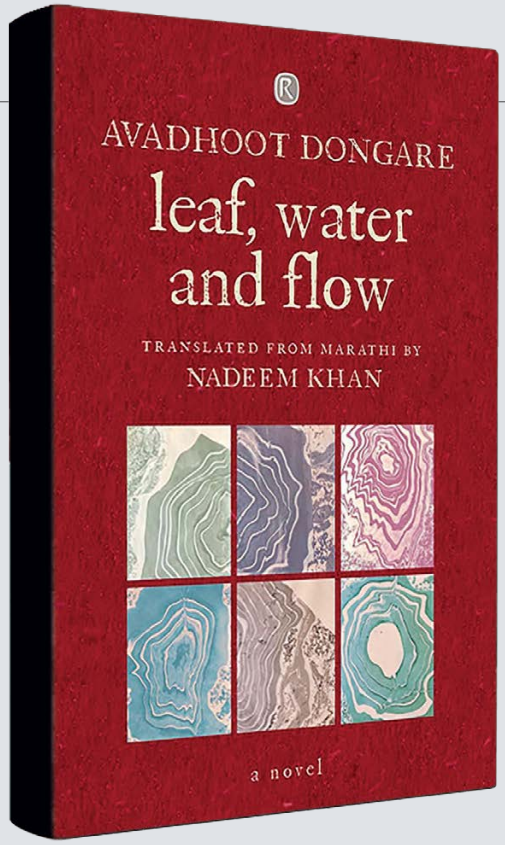
Found in Translation

*Translation was alive and well in 2024, as **Arunava Sinha**'s pick of his favourite translations from the year affirms*



TREASURER OF PIGGY BANKS
By Vinod Kumar Shukla
(Translated from the Hindi by Arvind Krishna Mehrotra)
WESTLAND
₹**399; 208** pages

When one poet translates another, a third is born. This is overwhelmingly true of Arvind Krishna Mehrotra's English version of Vinod Kumar Shukla's poem. In his Hindi writing, Shukla persistently refuses to burst into meaning or create drama or, indeed, provide any kind of aha! moment in his poetry. He examines his place in his immediate surroundings, observing with a perspective that offers no illumination, which itself becomes a way of looking at the world that the reader makes sense of. And Mehrotra, himself a poet laurate of the bare and the spare, both reflects and refracts this literature in English in a way that makes the reading of each poem a near-perfect experience.



LEAF, WATER AND FLOW
By Avadhoot Dongare
(Translated from the Marathi by Nadeem Khan)
RATNA BOOKS
₹**599; 256** pages

It

It takes fiction to make us see the world in ways we can scarcely imagine. The connectedness of things in the scaffolding of power comes to the forefront in Avadhoot Dongare's extraordinary Marathi novel—a word that can scarcely do justice to this creation that loops back on itself and brings the reader into its page by closing the space between them and the text. There are people here, and there are also objects, and there is not just narration but also commentary, making for a shapelessly knitted fabric. The Maoist political landscape is both setting and character, and stories abound without being manipulated into a consistent narrative. Nadeem Khan dances alongside the Marathi in English, matching it move for move with his dexterous translation. A reminder of what fiction can be in all its glory.